

NOTEFLIGHT

Wired magazine's GeekDad talks about the latest web toy that has caught his son's fancy - Noteflight - an online music writing application that lets you create, view, print and hear music notation with professional quality, right in your web browser. Sure beats music lessons and it's highly addictive for budding musicians. <http://bit.ly/wv08112>

RATINGS WILL RUIN WIKIPEDIA



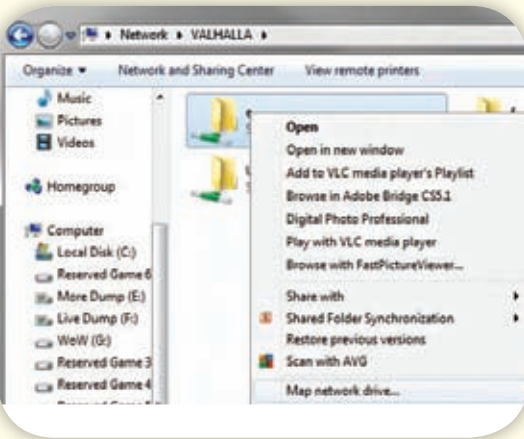
An article on Gizmodo argues that the new and seemingly beneficial system of rating articles on Wikipedia may not work like it's supposed to. Find out what can go wrong. <http://gizmo.do/wv08117>

10 GADGET GIFTS FOR GEEKY STUDENTS

ZDnet compiles a picture gallery of everything that a student would desire. From a digital pen that has an inbuilt infrared camera and can do 200 hours of lectures to a piggy bank with an LCD screen and digital counter. <http://zd.net/wv08118>

THE SPINNING HEATSINK

A new heat sink is being developed that doesn't require a fan. The entire heatsink itself spins at high speeds to dissipate heat more efficiently. It is immune to dust, and is supposed to save energy too. ExteemTech did a Q&A with the inventor. Read the interview here: <http://bit.ly/prmAw7>



work panel. Click Start (the Flag button), type Network, and click Network from the list of programs. You should see your drive in the list of network devices — right click it, select “Map network drive...” and voila.

You should now see your network-attached USB hard drive in My Computer. For all intents and purposes, this is a normal hard drive as far as your computer is concerned — which means it's time to set up our backup software.

In every case, set up your backup plan as normal — and just be sure to select your network-attached USB drive as the destination.

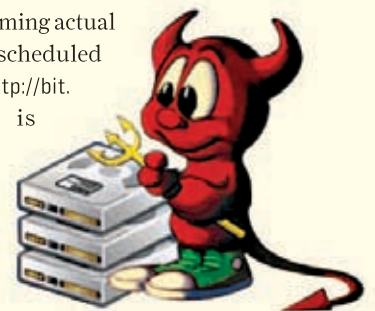
MAC, LINUX & NETWORK-ATTACHED STORAGE

You may have noticed that this DIY Time Capsule is basically a cheap and not-very-functional network-attached storage (NAS) device — and for a few dollars more, it's probably worth making your own FreeNAS box (<http://bit.ly/mfreenas>). With a NAS, you inherit the Time Capsulesque functionality, but you gain more security and control, the ability to use more exciting file systems, and ultimately you have a Linux-like server that can be bent into doing just about anything: downloading torrents, streaming media to a PS3 or Xbox, crunching SETI, and so on.

As far as making your own Mac-compatible network-attached USB drive, the process is much the same as above — but you'll need to use a little hack (<http://lifehack.kr/timehllh>) to force the new drive to appear in Time Machine. Once it appears, however, your cheap-and-cheerful DIY Time Capsule should function in exactly the same way as the real thing.

Linux users: follow the same route as Windows users, but instead of mapping a network drive you'll need to do a little command line mounting (<http://bit.ly/dlmount>) to make the drive usable.

For performing actual backups, scheduled rsync (<http://bit.ly/nClt5x>) is pretty darn good.



CONFIGURATION

For the most part, configuring your wireless router to share the USB hard drive across the network should be easy. The hard drive should be immediately accessible across the network, but you may need to log into the router's control panel and make sure that the hard drive has been detected. If you're trying to connect to the hard drive using Windows, make sure the router is part of the same workgroup. If you already have a DSL or Cable modem/router acting as DHCP server, disable DHCP on your DIY Time Capsule and assign it a static IP.

Once the router is happily connected to the network and has successfully initialized the hard drive, you should be able to access the drive by opening Explorer and visiting \\Router_IP_address\ — if everything's worked, you should see a folder icon with a label like “FreeAgent” or “FlashDrive” or “Removable”. Right click the icon and select “Map network drive...” Pick any drive letter you like, make sure “Reconnect at logon” is selected, and click Finish.

If this method doesn't work (if you don't know the router's IP address), you can also access the drive through Windows 7's Net-

SOFTWARE

You'll be unsurprised to learn that Windows offers plenty of good solutions that mirror Time Machine's automatic, incremental backup functionality. The easiest solution, though not the most functional, is to actually use Windows 7's built-in Backup and Restore (<http://bit.ly/micbackup>), which is more than capable of performing your backups.

If you want a little more control, or if you use Windows XP, Genie Timeline (<http://bit.ly/gtimeline>) is excellent and provides continuous, in-the-background coverage, like Time Machine — but costs money; ditto Oops! Backup (<http://www.altaro.com/>) and Acronis True Image (<http://bit.ly/atimage>). As far as free options go, EASEUS Todo Backup (<http://bit.ly/todoback>) is probably the best, but it doesn't support continuous backups; you can schedule a backup to run every hour or two, though.

It's also worth noting that if you're only looking to mirror a few directories to mitigate the risk of hard drive failure, Microsoft's SyncToy (<http://bit.ly/msynctoy>) is an excellent choice — it's not a backup tool, however; there is no magical “Restore” button.